

Activity 8.1 - Continental Drift

INVESTIGATION 8.1

Continental drift

AIM To create a simple model to demonstrate continental drift

Materials:

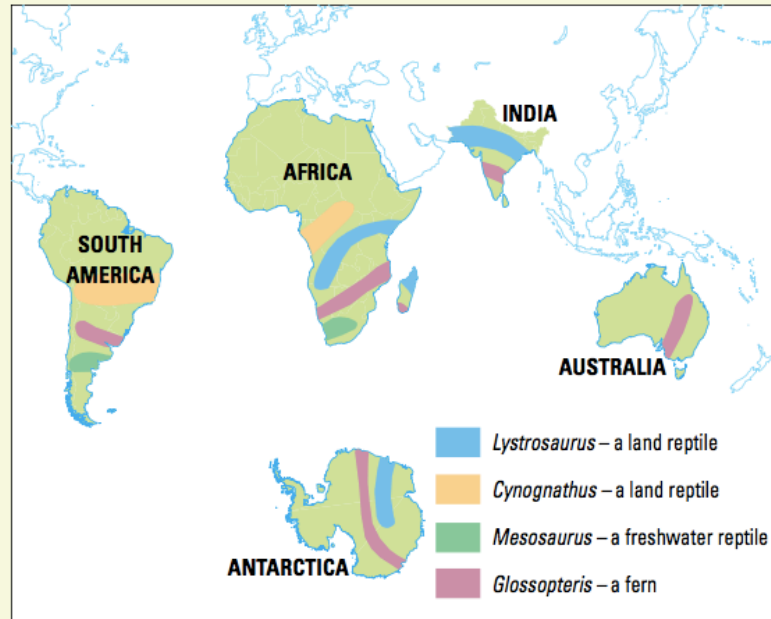
enlarged copy of the map above
scissors

METHOD

- ▶ Cut out the continents from the enlarged copy of the map above.
- ▶ Examine the distribution of fossils on each continent.
- ▶ Rearrange the continents into one supercontinent by matching the distribution of fossils.

DISCUSS AND EXPLAIN

- 1 How do you think the distribution of fossils helps to prove Wegener's theory of continental drift?
- 2 Suggest at least one other way in which the continents can be put together.



Distribution of a selection of fossils of ancient organisms

Cut out the continents on the following page and see what happens.

Take a photo and add it in the space to the right. Answer Q 1 and 2.

